



Kaleidoscope

By LOUISE MAXON REA

Bill Latham Day Tuesday, proclaimed by Mayor Pro-Tem E. H. Baeza, was a great day for the retiring editor of The El Paso Times and the hundreds of friends who attended a luncheon in his honor in El Paso Country Club. The "roast" began with Master of Ceremonies R. W. "Pete" Lee, editor of El Paso Herald-Post, introducing the Rev. Herman Green, associate pastor of First Baptist Church which Bill attends. Remarks from a former staff member, Art Leibson; fellow Lion and good friend Andy Cohen; Bessie Simpson, who worked on the old World News with Bill during his bachelor days; Frank Feuille, publisher of The Times, and intermittent comments from Pete Lee kept the large crowd entertained during an excellent luncheon.

Then after Mr. Baeza proclaimed the day in honor of Mr. Latham, he was made an admiral in the El Paso County Navy by County Judge Udell Moore, with all privileges thereto appertaining. Clinton Wolfe presented a letter of appreciation and a plaque from the real U.S. Navy. Dorr Miller, president of El Paso Chamber of Commerce, made a presentation on behalf of citizens of El Paso and Janice Windle, executive director of El Paso Bicentennial Commission, presented the honor guest with a special commemorative plaque marking the 200th anniversary of our country.

Sugar Goodman climaxed the day with a number of gifts from various groups participating, a book in beginning journalism and a certificate for him to join any first-year journalism school in the city system, from J. M. Whitaker, superintendent of El Paso Independent School District; a pet rock, complete with baby blue leather leash, from Mrs. Franklin Kitchen and members of El Paso Garden Clubs, and an exquisite silver topped crystal box from all groups participating. An original design of a Conquistador by Richard Myklebust adorns the lid of the box, a beautiful tribute to a wonderful man from some of his friends.

References to Bill's unabashed patriotism and love of his country, city, friends, home and family were many. It was fitting to me, that at the conclusion of all the speeches, Freeman Harris, with his glorious voice, led the group in singing "God Bless America."

Much credit should go to Mrs. Charles (Winona) McKay, who conceived the idea for the party and contacted so many people to help make it a success; to members of all the 17 sponsoring organizations, and especially those who took on the monumental task of taking reservations, Mrs. Joe Battle, Mrs. Donald Payton and Mrs. Sam W. Ward. And my personal thanks to everyone who participated in any way, by taking part in a spontaneous tribute to a great guy, my boss, Bill Latham. It was a day to be long remembered and will be one I cherish. Thank you, El Paso!